Who Can Tell Us? Questions About Dad's Care for the Agency, the Nurse and the Family

Fifteen questions, sorted by who can answer them, with room to write what they say.

You have a question about Dad's Tuesday visit, and it isn't obvious whether it belongs to the agency, the nurse or your sister. Each question below sits under the person most likely to know.

Ask them as they are, and write the answer under each one. This guide doesn't answer the questions and doesn't say which matters most. They are questions, not complaints, and nobody has to be in the wrong for you to ask them.

The agency scheduler or coordinator

Whoever at the agency keeps Dad's visit schedule. The job title varies, so ask for the person who sets his visits.

1. Which visits are on Dad's schedule each week, on which days and at what times?

2. What is each visit meant to cover? Could we have that in writing?

3. Is a record kept of each visit, and can the family see it?

4. When his usual aide is away, who comes, and how are we told?

The nurse, or whoever looks after Dad's care plan

1. Which of Dad's needs does the care plan cover, and which does it leave to the family?

2. When was the plan last looked at, and when will it be looked at again?

3. Here is what we've seen for ourselves and what we've only been told. Which of these would you like to know more about?

4. If a need turns out to have nobody covering it, who do we bring that to?

5. We have some questions about his health and his medications. Who should each one go to?

Your sister, or whoever fills in

She is there more than anyone. Ask because she knows, not to check on her.

1. What do you do for Dad in a usual week that isn't on any schedule?

2. Which of those things did you expect someone else to be doing?

3. How are you managing it, and is there any part you'd like someone else to take?

Dad

1. How is the help going, from where you sit?

2. Is there anything you'd like in your week that isn't happening now?

Your care consultant

Someone who meets Dad as well as talking with the family, and looks at the whole picture.

1. Given our list of what's covered, what we haven't confirmed and what nobody covers, what else would you want to know?

What this guide doesn't do

It doesn't answer these questions, tell you which one comes first, or say what an answer means for Dad's care. If something seems urgent to you, say so to the person you're talking with.

Ready for the next step?

You have your questions sorted by who can answer them, and soon some answers. The care interview walks through Dad's situation area by area, so each answer has a place to go, and turns them into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

A few of these questions follow Medicare's home health care booklet, which is written for Medicare-certified home health agencies, and the Family Caregiver Alliance's page on in-home help. The grouping by role is ours.

1. Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services, Medicare & Home Health Care (CMS Product No. 10969)
2. Family Caregiver Alliance, Hiring In-Home Help

From the Family Care Roadmap · Richard Ladson, Certified Medicaid Planner. Draft for review, generated 2026-10-04.